

OSIC launches AI competition to help pulmonary fibrosis patients

The Open Source Imaging Consortium (OSIC) has launched the US\$ 55,000 OSIC Pulmonary Fibrosis Progression. This is an AI-focused challenge to predict lung function decline in people living with pulmonary fibrosis. The competition is administered by data science community platform Kaggle and will run from October 6, 2020.

OSIC was created to enable rapid advances in the fight against fibrosing interstitial lung diseases (ILDs) such as idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis (IPF), and other respiratory conditions including emphysema. It aims to bring together radiologists, clinicians, and computational scientists from around the world to improve imaging-based approaches to diagnosis, prognosis and therapy.

Elizabeth Estes, the consortium's executive director, said, "OSIC was created to bring divergent groups together to look at new ways of fighting complex lung disease. In addition to utilising expertise from academia, industry and philanthropy, we wanted to introduce clinicians to the broader artificial intelligence and machine learning community to see if new eyes and new tools could help us move forward, faster. We are excited to see the progress that can be made for patients all over the world."

Dr Kevin Brown, National Jewish Health and OSIC's lead pulmonologist said, "The heterogeneity of outcomes in this disease complicates clinical decision-making for individual patients, increasing their anxiety and fear. Overcoming this challenge will help clinicians provide clarity to our patients, and ultimately improve treatment trial design and accelerate the clinical development of novel therapies."

Autodesk, Bill.com, HERE Technologies, LiveRamp, Just Eat, Nationwide, Neustar, Nike, and Spotify, among others.



Mike Dolan, vice president and general manager, Linux Foundation Projects, said, "Where there is technology disruption, there are opportunities for business transformation. FinOps is exactly this and represents a shift in operations strategy, process and culture. This type of disruption and transformation is also where community and industrywide collaboration play critical roles in enabling a whole new market opportunity. We're pleased to be the place where that work can happen."

FinOps helps companies to ensure that they get the most value from every dollar spent in the cloud. It pushes accountability for spending to the edge where developers control purchasing decisions. It also provides a new set of centralised processes to maximise efficiency of purchases and the ability to allocate spending to teams.

According to Gartner, cloud spending is forecast to exceed US\$ 360 billion by 2022. It said that finance teams have very little insight into where that spend is being allocated within their organisations. This leads to uncontrolled costs that are not properly forecast or documented along with lack of standardised tooling. This can lead to major losses or errors in critical accounting practices. Procurement of IT infrastructure has moved from taking days or weeks to seconds or minutes. It has accelerated application development but dramatically decreased efficiencies in financial operations.

Apromore raises US\$ 4.57 million in funding

Apromore, the developer of open source process mining technology, has raised US\$ 4.57 million (EUR 4 million) in a series A round led by German business process management specialist GBTEC. It also saw an investment from Melbourne based consulting and technology firm Leonardo and the University of Melbourne, which helped to incubate Apromore before its spin-off.

The company said that the investment is coupled with a strategic partnership with GBTEC. It will see GBTEC offer Apromore's process mining